MIL-C-342H
30 April 1986
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-342G
24 July 1974

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CLOTH, WIND RESISTANT, POPLIN, COTTON

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers the requirements for rip stop poplin, wind resistant cotton cloth.

1.2 Classification. The cloth shall be of one type in the following classes as specified (see 6.2, 6.6, and 6.7):

Class A - Plain finish (untreated)

Class B - Water repellent treated

Class C - Fire resistant treated

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8305

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-T-276 - Thread, Cotton
PPP-P-1134 - Packaging of Cotton and Cotton-Synthetic Fiber Blend Fabrics (Excluding Duck Fabrics)

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-4 - Glossary of Fabric Imperfections
FED-STD-191 - Textile Test Methods

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

OTHER GOVERNMENT DOCUMENT

FEDERAL TRADE COMMISSION

Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Federal Trade Commission, Washington, DC 20580.)

* 2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF TEXTILE CHEMISTS AND COLORISTS (AATCC)

Chromatic Transference Scale

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists, P.O. Box 12215, Research Triangle Park, NC 27709.)

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AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 1424 - Tear Resistance of Woven Fabrics by Falling Pendulum (Elmendorf) Apparatus

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets, or MS standards), the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard sample. The finished cloth shall match the standard sample for shade and appearance and shall unless otherwise indicated (see 3.4.3), be equal to or better than the standard sample with respect to all characteristics for which the standard sample is referenced (see 6.4).

3.2 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2, and 6.3).

3.3 Material. The cotton shall be carded, combed, drawn, spun and twisted into 2-ply yarn for the warp and 2-ply or single yarn for the filling.

3.4 Color. The color shall be as specified and shall match the standard sample (see 6.2, 6.4, and 6.5).

* 3.4.1 Labile sulfur. The use of dyes and compounds containing elementary sulfur capable of oxidation to sulfuric acid is prohibited. The dyes shall be chosen and applied so that the dyed and finished cloth shall contain no more labile sulfur than that shown by the standard sample when tested as specified in 4.4.3. When a standard sample is not available, the dyed and finished cloth shall show no more than a slight trace of labile sulfur as defined in the test method when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

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* 3.4.2 Matching. The color and appearance shall match the standard sample when viewed under filtered tungsten lamps that approximate artificial daylight and that have a correlated color temperature of 7000 ± 500 K, with illumination of 100 ± 20 foot candles and shall be a good match to the standard sample under incandescent lamplight at 2300 ± 100 K.

* 3.4.3 Colorfastness. The dyed and finished cloth shall show fastness to laundering (after 3 cycles), perspiration, wet dry-cleaning, and light equal to or better than the standard sample, or equal to or better than the rating of "good", when tested as specified in 4.4.3. The cloth shall show fastness to crocking equal to or better than the standard sample or shall have an AATCC Chromatic Transference Scale rating not lower than 3.5, when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

* 3.5 Physical requirements. The finished cloth shall conform to the requirements specified in table I when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

TABLE I. Physical requirements

Class	Weight per sq yd (ounces) min	Weight per sq yd (ounces) max	Yarns per inch, minimum Warp	Yarns per inch, minimum Filling	Breaking strength, minimum (pounds) Warp	Breaking strength, minimum (pounds) Filling	Tearing strength, minimum (pounds) Warp	Tearing strength, minimum (pounds) Filling	Air permeability (cu ft/ minute/ sq foot), max (avg) (initial)
A	5.7	7.0	104	52	110	68	4.0	4.0	18.0
B	5.7	7.2	104	52	100	60	4.0	4.0	15.0
C	7.0	8.0	104	52	90	60	2.0	3.0	15.0

* 3.5.1 Width. The width of the cloth shall be as specified (see 6.2) and shall be the minimum acceptable width inclusive of the selvage when fly shuttle looms or shuttleless looms with tuck-in selvage looms are used. For all other shuttleless looms, the width measurement shall be made between the last warp yarn on each side excluding the protruding fringe(s).

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3.5.2 Weave. The weave shall be plain with reinforcement ribs uniformly spaced in the warp and filling. The warp repeat shall be two ends weaving as one followed by 23 single ends (total 25 ends per repeat). The filling repeat shall be two picks inserted into the same shed followed by 12 single picks (total 14 picks per repeat).

3.6 Finish. The cloth shall be singed, desized, mercerized, and dyed. The use of resin pigments in the dyeing or finishing of the cloth is prohibited. The type and character of finish shall conform to that shown by the standard sample.

* 3.7 Nonfibrous material. The untreated cloth of classes A, B, and C shall contain not more than 2.0 percent starch and protein content (including chloroform-soluble and water-soluble material) when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.8 Dimensional stability. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the finished cloth shall not shrink or elongate more than 2.0 percent in the direction of either the warp or the filling when tested as specified in 4.4.3. The preshrinking process used shall not be identified by name or trademark on either the cloth, ticket, or package.

3.9 Water repellency (class B).

3.9.1 Treatment. The cloth shall be given an approved Quarpel-type (see 6.6) water repellent treatment and shall conform to the requirements of 3.9.1.1 and 3.9.1.2 when tested as specified in 4.4.3. The use of materials other than approved water repellents and sodium acetate buffer (and acetic acid) is prohibited.

3.9.1.1 Spray rating. The results of the three individual determinations on the sample unit for spray rating shall be equal to or better than ratings 90, 90, 80 when tested initially, and 70, 70, 70 after one laundering as required by 3.8 when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.9.1.2 Resistance to organic liquid. The water repellent treated cloth shall not show wetting by n-dodecane initially when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

* 3.10 Flame resistance (class C). The cloth shall be given an approved durable flame-resistant treatment (see 6.7). The finished cloth shall have an average time for flaming of not more than 2.0 seconds, an after-glow of not more than 6.0 seconds, and an average char length of not more than 5.0 inches before and after 15 cycles of laundering when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

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* 3.11 pH. The pH value of the water extract of the finished cloth shall be no less than 5.0 nor more than 8.5 when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

* 3.12 Seam efficiency. The finished cloth shall have a seam efficiency of not less than 80 percent when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.13 Length and put-up. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the cloth shall be furnished in continuous lengths, each not less than 40 yards. The cloth shall be put up on rolls as specified in 5.1.

3.14 Fiber identification. Each roll shall be labeled, ticketed, or invoiced for fiber content in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

3.15 Marking. The face side of the cloth shall be identified by applying a stamping on that side of the cloth with the word "FACE" at each end of the piece.

3.16 Workmanship. The finished cloth shall be clean and free of holes, cuts, tears or cloth defects, such as slubs, jerked-in filling, uneven weaving or tension, waviness and excessive neppiness. It shall possess the seam efficiency and be of the color and size specified in this document. The demerit points per 100 square yards, when calculated as specified in section 4, shall not exceed the maximum point value.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this document shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the document shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

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4.1.2 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), it shall be visually examined for appearance, color, and finish and shall be tested in accordance with the methods specified in 4.4.3.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.4.2 End item examination.

* 4.4.2.1 Yard-by-yard examination. Each roll in the sample shall be examined on the printed side only. When the total yardage in the roll does not exceed 100 yards, the entire yardage in the roll shall be examined. When the total yardage in the roll exceeds 100 yards, only 100 yards shall be examined. All defects as defined in section I of FED-STD-4, which are clearly noticeable at normal inspection distance (3 feet), shall be scored and assigned demerit points as listed in 4.4.2.1.1, except that only those slubs and knots that exceed the limits shown on Sears Fabric Defect Scale (see 6.8) "D" or 3 1/2, as applicable, for slubs and "C" for knots shall be scored. No linear yard (increments of one yard on the measuring device of the inspection machine) from any one roll within the sample shall be penalized more than 4 points. The sample size shall be 20 rolls selected from 20 containers. For determination of acceptability on the average quality of the lot, the lot shall be unacceptable if the points per 100 square yards exceed the following values:

35.0 points for dyed cloth
40.0 points for white cloth

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For determination of acceptability on the individual roll quality basis, the lot shall be unacceptable if the points per 100 square yards of two or more individual rolls exceed the following values:

53.0 points for dyed cloth
60.0 points for white cloth

If one roll exceeds the point value per 100 square yards, a second sample of 20 rolls shall be examined for individual roll quality examination. If one or more rolls in the second sample exceeds the point value, the lot shall be rejected. Point computation for the lot quality and individual roll quality shall be as follows:

$$\frac{\text{Total points scored in sample} \times 3600}{\text{Contracted width of cloth (inches)} \times \text{total yards inspected}} = \text{Points per 100 square yards}$$

4.4.2.1.1 Demerit points. Demerit points shall be assigned as follows:

For defects 3 inches or less in any dimension	- one point
For defects exceeding 3 inches, but not exceeding 6 inches in any dimension	- two points
For defects exceeding 6 inches, but not exceeding 9 inches in any dimension	- three points
For defects exceeding 9 inches in any dimension	- four points

The following defects, when present, shall be scored four points for each yard in which they occur:

Baggy, ridgy or wavy cloth
Width less than specified
Poor dye penetration, mottled, streaky or cloudy
Not singed
Excessive neppiness

4.4.2.2 Length examination.

4.4.2.2.1 Individual rolls. During the yard-by-yard examination, each roll in the sample shall be examined for length. Any length found to be less than the minimum specified, or more than two yards less than the length marked on

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the ticket, shall be considered a defect with respect to length. The lot shall be unacceptable if two or more rolls in the sample are defective in respect to length.

4.4.2.2.2 Total yardage in sample. The lot shall be unacceptable if the total of the actual lengths of rolls in the sample is less than the total of the lengths marked on the tickets.

* 4.4.2.3 Shade and appearance examination. During the yard-by-yard examination, each roll in the sample shall be examined for shade and appearance. Any roll in the sample off shade, shaded side to side, side to center, or end to end, or any roll that does not have the same appearance as the standard sample, shall be cause for rejection of the entire lot represented by the sample.

4.4.2.4 Roll identification examination. During the yard-by-yard examination, each roll in the sample shall be examined for these defects. The lot shall be unacceptable if two or more rolls in the sample contain identification of the preshrinkage process by name or trade-mark on the cloth or ticket, or are not labeled or ticketed in accordance with the Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act, or the face stamping missing from either or both ends.

* 4.4.3 End item testing. The cloth shall be tested for the characteristics listed in table II. The methods of testing specified in FED-STD-191, wherever applicable, and as listed in table II shall be followed. The physical and chemical values specified in section 3, except where otherwise specified, apply to the results of the determinations made on the sample unit for test purposes as specified in the applicable test method. The sample unit shall be 1/4-yard full width of the dyed cloth, prior to application of the water repellent treatment (see 3.7) for determination of the starch and protein content (including chloroform-soluble and water-soluble material), and five continuous yards full width of the finished cloth for all other physical and chemical tests. All test reports shall contain the individual values utilized in expressing the final result. The sample size shall be as shown in the list below. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet any requirement specified.

Lot size (yards)	Sample size (units)
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

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TABLE II. Test methods

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method
Material		
Cotton identification	3.3	1200 1/
Yarn ply:		
Warp	3.3	Visual 1/ 2/
Filling	3.3	Visual 1/ 2/
Presence of labile sulfur	3.4.1	2020
Colorfastness to:		
Laundering (after 3 cycles)	3.4.3	5610 3/ 4/
Crocking	3.4.3	5651
Wet drycleaning	3.4.3	5622
Perspiration	3.4.3	5680
Light	3.4.3	5660
Weight	3.5	5041
Yarns per inch	3.5	5050
Breaking strength	3.5	5100
Tearing strength	3.5	ASTM D 1424
Air permeability	3.5	5450
Weave and repeat	3.5.2	Visual 2/
Mercerization	3.6	Microscopic examination 2/
Presence of resin pigments	3.6	1/
Nonfibrous material	3.7	2611
Dimensional stability	3.8	5550

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TABLE II. Test methods - Continued

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method
Water repellent (class B)	3.9.1	5/
Spray rating (class B):		
Initial	3.9.1.1	5526
After one laundering	3.9.1.1	5550 and 5526
Resistance to organic liquid (class B):		
Initial	3.9.1.2	4.5.1
Flame resistance (class C):		
Initial	3.10	5903
After laundering (15 cycles)	3.10	5556 3/ and 5903
pH	3.11	2811
Seam efficiency	3.12	5110 6/

1/ Unless otherwise specified, a certificate of compliance shall be submitted and will be acceptable for the stated requirement.

2/ One determination shall be made from each sample unit and the result reported as "pass" or "fail".

3/ The specimens must be dried after each laundering cycle.

4/ On the color transfer cloth evaluation, only the stain on the cotton fibers of the color transfer cloth shall be evaluated.

5/ The contractor shall report the water repellent used and certify that no other material (except the specified buffer and acetic acid) has been added.

6/ The needle shall measure 0.040 inch (± 0.001 inch) across the blade at the eye. The cotton thread shall be type IA1, ticket No. 40-3 ply in the needle and ticket No. 60-3 ply in the loopers, conforming to V-T-276.

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4.4.4 Packaging inspection. The inspection shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of PPP-P-1134.

4.5 Methods of inspection.

4.5.1 Test for resistance to organic liquid. Place a small specimen of the cloth on a smooth horizontal surface, face up. Using a pipette or eye dropper, gently deposit one drop of n-dodecane on the surface of the specimen. After one minute, examine the specimen under light at an angle. Absence of light reflectance at the fabric-drop interface shall be taken as evidence of wetting. Three specimens (or areas) taken at various locations across the sample shall be tested. Evidence of wetting on one or more specimens shall be considered cause for rejection of the lot represented by the sample.

* 5. PACKAGING

5.1 Put-up and preservation. Put-up and preservation shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Levels A and Commercial. The cloth shall be put up on rolls and preserved in accordance with the applicable requirements of PPP-P-1134.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Levels A, B, and Commercial packing. The cloth shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of PPP-P-1134.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipments shall be marked in accordance with PPP-P-1134.

6. NOTES

* 6.1 Intended use. The cloth is intended for use in the manufacture of clothing and equipage items. The class B cloth, although water repellent treated, will not provide rain protection due to its high air permeability. The class C cloth is intended to be used as a component of the 'CVC' face mask.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. Class required (see 1.2).
c. When first article is required (see 3.2, 4.3, and 6.3).
d. Color required (see 3.4).

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e. Width required (see 3.5.1).
f. When dimensional stability is other than specified (see 3.8).
g. When length is other than specified (see 3.13).
h. Selection of applicable levels of put-up, preservation, and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

* 6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR-52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample consisting of 5 yards of the finished cloth. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 Standard sample. For access to standard sample, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.5 Dye formulation. Satisfactory results in achieving the proper shade for Olive Green 107 and colorfastness have been obtained with an appropriate combination of the following dyes:

Vat Black 25, CI 69525
Vat Green 3, CI 69500/1
Vat Green 8, CI 71050,

that are shaded with either or both of the following:

Vat Brown 3, CI 609015/6
Vat Yellow of suitable fastness

The redness of the shade should result from the predominant use of the main colors and not from the shading colors.

6.6 Quarpel water repellent. The "Quarpel-type" water repellent treatment consists of the co-application of an emulsified fluorocarbon and a buffered quaternary ammonium salt type of repellent. Approval of such components and combinations is the responsibility of the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, and is based on extensive tests, including those for toxicity, which are not set forth in this document. Because of the time necessary to conduct a full evaluation, only those chemical treatments already approved and so listed in the invitation for bid or request for proposal shall be considered acceptable for the related acquisition.

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* 6.7 Approval of flame-resistant treatment formulas. Approval of formulas is the responsibility of the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, and is based on extensive tests, including those for toxicity, which are not set forth in this document. Because of the time required to evaluate and approve new formulas (approximately 6 months), only those formulas already approved will be considered acceptable for the related acquisition. Information pertaining to approval of new formulas should be obtained from the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center. The list of approved formulas may be obtained from the contracting activity. As part of the approval testing of new flame-retardant treatments, the finished cloth should have an after-flame of not more than 2.0 seconds and should not melt or drop flaming pieces when tested in accordance with Method 5905 of FED-STD-191.

* 6.8 Fabric defect scales. Fabric Defect Replica Kits are available from Sears, Roebuck and Company, Department 817 (Attn: BSC 23-29), Sears Tower, Chicago, IL 60684.

6.9 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, deletions, corrections) from previous issues were made. This was done as a convenience only, and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-342H	Cloth, Wind Resistant, Poplin, Cotton

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

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7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
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